



The
University
Of
Sheffield.

Application 073310

Section A: Applicant details

Date application started:

Tue 24 March 2026 at 10:27

First name:

Edward

Last name:

Cox

Email:

ecox7@sheffield.ac.uk

Programme name:

Computer Science

Module name:

Dissertation

Last updated:

30/03/2026

Department:

Computer Science

Applying as:

Undergraduate

Research project title:

VCT Match Predictor: Utilising Alexa to Provide Intuitive Valorant Esports Predictions

Has your research project undergone academic review, in accordance with the appropriate process?

Yes

Similar applications:

- not entered -

Section B: Basic information

Supervisor

Name

Email

Roger Moore

r.k.moore@sheffield.ac.uk

Proposed project duration

Start date (of data collection):

Wed 1 April 2026

Anticipated end date (of project)

Wed 13 May 2026

3: Project code (where applicable)

Project externally funded?

No

Project code
- *not entered* -

Suitability

Takes place outside UK?

No

Involves NHS?

No

Health and/or social care human-interventional study?

No

ESRC funded?

No

Likely to lead to publication in a peer-reviewed journal?

No

Led by another UK institution?

No

Involves human tissue?

No

Clinical trial or a medical device study?

No

Involves social care services provided by a local authority?

No

Is social care research requiring review via the University Research Ethics Procedure

No

Involves adults who lack the capacity to consent?

No

Involves research on groups that are on the Home Office list of 'Proscribed terrorist groups or organisations'?

No

Indicators of risk

Involves potentially vulnerable participants?

No

Involves potentially highly sensitive topics?

No

Section C: Summary of research

1. Aims & Objectives

I aim to gather people's views on the Alexa skill that I have made as part of my dissertation. The skill is a Valorant esports match predictor, where the user inputs two professional Valorant teams, and the skill will reply with who it thinks it going to win. I want to gather some opinions on the skill's ease of use, how well they believe Alexa understands their intentions, as well as any feedback/suggestions that they can give, so that I can write about this, and use it to improve the skill.

2. Methodology

These questions will be answered through the use of an anonymous google form (so that I am not storing any personal data). The questions will be a mix of 5-point Likert scale questions, and free text boxes, so that participants can exercise their thoughts into the form. The responses will be discussed anonymously in my report, and linked to any changes I did or did not make to the skill.

The proposed questions that the participant can access after reading through the information page and agreeing to the consent page are as follows:

Strongly Disagree - Strongly Agree questions:

As somebody interested in Valorant, I think that this project is useful.
I think that the skill is easy to use.
I think that the dialogue with Alexa feels natural.
Alexa accurately understands what I say.
Alexa prompts me in a way I understand when something went wrong.

Free text questions:

What do you like about the skill?
What other features would you like to see in the skill?
What do you think could be improved within the skill?
What do you think could be improved within the skill?
Any other thoughts?

The proposed google form can be viewed here: https://docs.google.com/forms/d/e/1FAIpQLSeaQW5EsXpw_IRmt-c2x79butvjdgBmXWfmbWd_awlWjYepZg/viewform?usp=header

3. Personal Safety

Have you completed your departmental risk assessment procedures, if appropriate?

Yes

Raises personal safety issues?

No

I will not be meeting any participants in person, and the topic of research is not a sensitive topic.

Section D: About the participants

1. Potential Participants

Members of the University of Sheffield video games society are likely participants, especially those who play the game 'Valorant'. I might also reach out to the same group of people within other universities.

2. Recruiting Potential Participants

I would post a message containing the information about my situation, the project, and the survey within relevant public channels in the university society's discord channels, which people viewing those channels can choose to interact with. I won't be approaching specific people.

2.1. Advertising methods

Will the study be advertised using the volunteer lists for staff or students maintained by IT Services? No

- not entered -

3. Consent

Will informed consent be obtained from the participants? (i.e. the proposed process) Yes

Yes. The second page of the form will be a consent form that the user has to agree to in order to advance to the next stage of participation. The first page will be information regarding the project, and what is expected of a participant. I will ensure that detail will be given as part of my online post giving potential participants enough information to decide whether they want to even open the link to the form let alone fill it in. The form will not collect any personal details.

4. Payment

Will financial/in kind payments be offered to participants? No

5. Potential Harm to Participants

What is the potential for physical and/or psychological harm/distress to the participants?

There is no potential for physical harm, as the form is completely online, and participants do not need to travel anywhere to complete it. There is also minimal harm for inconvenience, as reading the message, or interacting with the form is completely optional. Taking the time to fill in the form might be considered a minor inconvenience to the participants, however they are consensually filling it out.

How will this be managed to ensure appropriate protection and well-being of the participants?

The form is online-based, meaning that participants can fill it out whenever and wherever they want, as long as they have an internet connection. It is a short form (only three questions).

6. Potential harm to others who may be affected by the research activities

Which other people, if any, may be affected by the research activities, beyond the participants and the research team?

Nobody may be affected, as the only involved parties are myself and the informed participants.

What is the potential for harm to these people?

N/A

How will this be managed to ensure appropriate safeguarding of these people?

N/A

7. Reporting of safeguarding concerns or incidents

What arrangements will be in place for participants, and any other people external to the University who are involved in, or affected by, the research, to enable reporting of incidents or concerns?

The email address of the project supervisor will be attached to the form and the initial post, and it will be specified that this is the person to contact if any incidents occur. For any general incidents or concerns, participants can also contact me through the same platform that I posted the message on.

Who will be the Designated Safeguarding Contact(s)?

Roger Moore

How will reported incidents or concerns be handled and escalated?

I or Roger Moore will either be able to handle a concern, or if not, we will identify the most relevant person within the university to pass this concern up to.

Section E: Personal data

1. Use of personal data

Will any personal data be processed or accessed as part of the project?

No

Are you sure that no personal data will be processed or accessed during your project?

Yes

Section F: Supporting documentation

Information & Consent

Participant information sheets relevant to project?

No

Consent forms relevant to project?

No

Additional Documentation

External Documentation

Both the participation information and consent form can be seen as part of the google form:

https://docs.google.com/forms/d/e/1FAIpQLSeaQW5EsXpw_IRmt-c2x79butvjdgMxWfmbWd_awlWjYepZg/viewform

Section G: Declaration

Signed by:
Edward Cox
Date signed:
Sun 29 March 2026 at 16:58

Official notes

- *not entered* -